



AEO Intelligence Report

Answer Engine Optimisation Analysis — prepared by Nomadic Digital



OVERALL AEO SCORE

The Royal Shakespeare Company currently has very limited visibility in AI-driven answer engines, scoring just 14.3% across key theatre-related queries, only ranking for one of seven questions ("best theatre productions in Stratford-upon-Avon"). This is despite RSC's strong offline brand recognition, indicating a significant gap between real-world prestige and digital answer engine optimization. Technically, the site lacks foundational AEO infrastructure: there is no llms.txt or llms-full.txt file, and critically, no structured schema markup exists anywhere on the site, making it difficult for AI crawlers and answer engines to understand and surface RSC's content. While robots.txt exists and doesn't block crawlers (a positive baseline), the absence of schema and AI-specific directives leaves the RSC well behind competitors like National Theatre, Donmar Warehouse, and Almeida Theatre, who each achieve double the visibility score.

TECHNICAL AUDIT

- ✓ robots.txt — AI crawlers allowed
- ✗ llms.txt — missing
- ✗ llms-full.txt — missing
- ✗ Structured Schema — missing

AI VISIBILITY

Royal Shakespeare Company (RSC)	14%
National Theatre	29%
Globe Theatre	0%
Donmar Warehouse	29%
Almeida Theatre	29%
Barbican Centre	0%

VISIBILITY INSIGHT

RSC's visibility score of 14.3% trails significantly behind top competitors like National Theatre, Donmar Warehouse, and Almeida Theatre, who each score 28.6%, indicating RSC is roughly half as discoverable in AI answer engines despite its global reputation.

KEY IMPROVEMENTS

- 01 Implement structured schema markup (Theatre, Event, Performance, and Organization schema types) sitewide to help answer engines accurately parse and surface RSC's productions, venues, and ticketing information.

- 02 Create and publish llms.txt and llms-full.txt files to explicitly guide AI crawlers toward RSC's most authoritative content on productions, booking, and company history.

- 03 Develop targeted, answer-optimized content that directly addresses common audience queries (e.g., "where to watch Shakespeare live," "how to book tickets," "top UK theatre companies") to close the visibility gap across all seven benchmark queries, not just one.

QUICK WIN

Implement Theatre and Event schema markup across the site immediately—this is the fastest way to help answer engines understand and surface RSC's productions, venues, and ticketing details, directly closing the gap with better-optimized competitors.